SAGE: Scalable Agentic Grounded Evaluation for Crop Disease Diagnosis

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Abstract

Plant disease diagnosis is critical for food security, yet training disease-recognition models that generalize across crops, pathogens, and field conditions remains challenging because labeled disease images are far less abundant and standardized than data for other biotic stresses such as insects or weeds. Frontier vision-language models offer new opportunities through improved visual reasoning, but they still struggle with fine-grained disease identification due to the lack of structured, crop-specific symptom knowledge. To address this gap, we curate the largest plant disease image–symptom dataset to date, covering 335 crops, 1,251 disease classes, and approximately 839K images, designed to support training-free, agentic disease prediction. A scalable automated pipeline generates source-grounded symptom descriptions in which each claim is linked to a verbatim web quote; domain experts validate sampled crops and reconcile disease-name variants across sources. As a baseline, we introduce an autonomous visual reasoning agent that identifies anatomical context, narrows candidate diseases using symptom knowledge, sequentially compares reference images, and produces a fully explainable reasoning trace. Incorporating symptom knowledge improves accuracy by 16.2 percentage points on average at the full reference budget, with consistent gains across all four evaluation crops. Because the framework only requires crop-specific reference images and symptom knowledge, it can be extended to new crops without retraining, while the agentic baseline can directly benefit from future improvements in foundation model capabilities. Dataset and code are available at: https://sage-dataset.github.io/.

1. Introduction

Infectious diseases reduce potential crop yields by an average of 40%, and by as much as 100% for many smallholders [18]. Accurate diagnosis is a prerequisite for treatment, yet it is limited by two gaps: no dataset is large or diverse enough across crops and diseases for diagnosis at scale, and no structured, verifiable symptom knowledge accompanies the images. Existing datasets advance the field but fall short—PlantVillage [18] (controlled conditions), PlantDoc [36] (13 species), and the leaf-focused LeafNet [29] and CDDM [21]—none combining broad crop coverage, multi-organ imagery (leaf, stem, root, seed, ear, head), and structured symptom metadata with source provenance. On the methods side, deep learning [15] and few-shot vision-language models [5, 40], including chain-of-thought [25, 42] and agentic [28] approaches, remain narrow in crop scope, require fine-tuning, or lack transparent reasoning grounded in traceable knowledge sources.

We address these gaps together (Figure 1) and contribute: (i) a multi-crop image dataset spanning 335 crops and 1,251 disease classes (∼839K images) with multi-organ coverage, assembled from established benchmarks, expert-curated collections, and community sources; (ii) a source-first disease registry pipeline that, given a crop name, automatically produces structured symptom knowledge with per-field provenance, every fact tied to a verbatim web quote; (iii) a training-free agentic diagnostic pipeline whose predictions come from an autonomous reasoning agent that emits an explainable trace of which references it examined and why; and (iv) a systematic evaluation across four crops of varying difficulty, multiple reference budgets, knowledge-base sources, and model tiers. Incorporating symptom knowledge improves accuracy by 16.2 percentage points on average at the full reference budget, with consistent gains across all four crops; because the framework needs only crop-specific reference images and symptom knowledge, it transfers to new crops without retraining and improves automatically as foundation models advance.

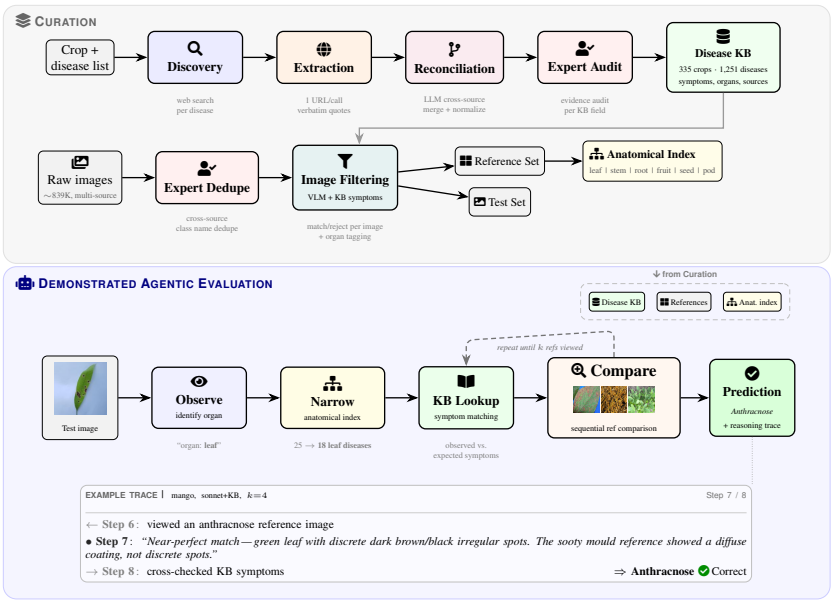


Figure 1. System overview. **Curation** (top): web pages become a source-cited KB (335 crops, 1,251 diseases) with an expert audit; raw images are deduped, filtered against the KB, and split into reference/test sets with an anatomical index. **Demonstrated agentic evaluation** (bottom): the agent observes the organ, narrows candidates, consults KB symptoms, and sequentially compares references, producing a prediction with a step-by-step trace.

Standard dataset
Image + Disease label

vs.

Ours
Image + Disease label
+ Organ tags (leaf, stem, root, …)
+ Symptom descriptions
+ Source URL + Verbatim quote

Example Entry

Disease: Tomato Early Blight
Pathogen: *A. linariae*
Organs: leaf, stem
Symptoms: Circular brown spots with concentric rings, target-like appearance, yellow halo
Source: hort.extension.wisc.edu
Quote: *"roughly circular, brown spots appear on leaves and stems… concentric rings appear giving a target-like appearance."*

Figure 2. Each disease carries source-cited metadata (organ tags, symptoms, verbatim quotes), unlike standard image+label datasets.

2. Related Work

Plant disease identification has been studied extensively with deep learning—CNNs (ResNet, VGG, DenseNet) reach high accuracy on controlled leaf benchmarks [15] but need large per-crop labeled sets and give opaque predictions—and datasets have grown in parallel: PlantVillage [18], PlantDoc [36], PlantWild [40], LeafNet [29], CDDM [21], and the dialogue-based AgMMU [14], which remain largely leaf-only, narrow in crop coverage, and lacking source-cited symptom metadata.

Vision-language models add few- and zero-shot recognition [5], with domain-tuned variants [7, 39], the AgReason benchmark [41], and structured-reasoning pipelines [25, 28, 42, 43], but each targets a narrow crop set and none combine autonomous reference selection with traceable symptom knowledge at scale—the gap our 839K-image, source-cited dataset and training-free agent address.

3. Dataset

No single existing dataset covers enough crops and diseases for general-purpose diagnosis, so we assembled SAGE from four complementary source categories (Figure 3): **established benchmarks** (PlantVillage [18], PlantDoc [36]); **recent large-scale datasets** (LeafNet [29], PlantWild [40]); **expert-curated multi-organ data** (soybean stress [15], MangoLeafBD [4]); and **community-contributed datasets** spanning rice [32], wheat rust [16], banana [22], bean [23], lettuce [19], cucumber [24], durian [13], eggplant [20], cotton [11], pumpkin [8], rose [12], strawberry [3], sugarcane [27], chickpea [17], cauliflower [9], coconut [10], and vanilla [26], plus a curated cucumber set [1], an augmented PlantVillage derivative [38], six HuggingFace aggregators [2, 6, 30, 31, 33, 34], and Bugwood imagery [37]. Per-dataset licenses are listed in Appendix B.

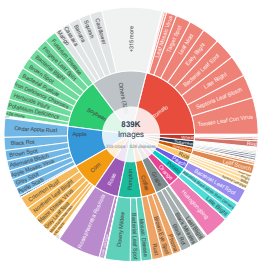


Figure 3. Image distribution across 335 crops and 1,251 disease classes (~839K images).

In total, SAGE spans 335 crops, 1,251 disease classes, and 838,936 images. We evaluate on four crops of varying difficulty—Soybean (25 classes), Corn (30), Tomato (20), and Mango (4)—with broader evaluation limited by the compute cost of agentic inference. Table 1 positions SAGE against prior datasets; QA/instruction-oriented works such as AgMMU [14], AgroBench [35], Agri-LLaVA [39], and AgroGPT [7] target different artifacts and are excluded from this per-image comparison.

Table 1. Comparison of plant disease datasets and benchmarks. **Diseases** counts disease-positive classes only (healthy/pest/weed classes excluded). **Task**: CLS classification, Det detection, VQA visual QA, OEQ open-ended QA, MCQ multiple choice. **Symptoms knowledge base**: ✓ if per-disease symptom descriptions are paired with images; parenthetical notes the source. **Demonstrated agentic eval**: ✓ if the dataset is shown to support step-by-step diagnostic reasoning with reference image comparison.

Dataset	Host species	Diseases	Images	Task	Multi-organ	Symptoms knowledge base	Demonstrated agentic eval
PlantVillage [18]	14	26	54,306	CLS	✗	✗	✗
PlantDoc [36]	13	17	2,598	CLS, Det	✗	✗	✗
PlantWild [40]	33	56	18,542	CLS	✗	✓ (LLM-generated)	✗
LeafNet [29]	22	97	186,000	VQA	✗	✓ (limited metadata)	✗
CDDM [21]	16	60	137,000	MCQ	✗	✗	✗
AgroBench [35]	203	682	3,745	MCQ	✓	✗	✗
SAGE (ours)	**335**	**1,251**	**838,936**	**CLS**	✓	✓ **(source-grounded)**	✓

Class-name deduplication across sources, registry-guided image filtering, anatomical-context tagging, and the reference/test splits are detailed in Appendix C.

4. Disease Registry Pipeline

The diagnostic agent (Section 5) needs structured disease knowledge to reason over images at inference. Querying a language model directly for disease symptoms risks hallucination and produces facts that cannot be verified. Our pipeline instead follows a source-first principle: it fetches real documents from the web, extracts only what is explicitly stated in those documents, and traces every fact back to its source with a verbatim quote. Given a crop name, three automated stages followed by an expert evidence audit (Figure 1) produce a fully cited disease registry.

The pipeline begins by issuing targeted web search queries for each disease in the crop, using the Claude CLI's web search capability to retrieve authoritative pages such as university extension factsheets, CABI datasheets, and APS disease compendia. Each retrieved page is then passed to the language model with an extraction prompt that requires the model to identify all diseases discussed on the page and extract structured fields: pathogen name, disease type, affected plant organs, and visual symptom descriptions. The model is required to provide a verbatim quote from the source text supporting each extracted field and is explicitly prevented from filling in information from its own knowledge. The raw extractions from multiple sources are then reconciled into a canonical registry: naming inconsistencies are resolved through LLM-based matching, conflicting claims across sources are tracked, and each field in the final registry retains its provenance (schema in Appendix D; expert audit results in Appendix Figure 8). Once generated for a crop, the registry is reused across all evaluation runs. The pipeline takes a crop name and disease list as input and runs end-to-end without per-crop tuning; because every field is anchored to a verbatim source quote, the registry can be audited directly rather than re-checked against a model's recall. We sample-audit registries end-to-end with an expert agronomist; field-level agreement on the audited crops is reported in Appendix Figure 8. Figure 4 shows where the released registries draw from: predominantly US land-grant extension publications, complemented by international compendia (CABI, Lucid Pacific Pests, PNW Plant Disease Handbook), peer-reviewed journals, and the multi-university Crop Protection Network.

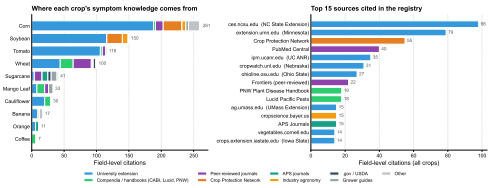


Figure 4. Sources backing the disease registry across all 10 crops with KBs released to date. Left: per-crop field-level citations stacked by source category. Right: top 15 cited domains across these KBs. Full KB and code: https://sage-dataset.github.io/.

5. Agentic Diagnostic Pipeline

Each test image is diagnosed by an autonomous reasoning agent that operates in a multi-turn loop. The agent receives three inputs: (1) the test image to classify, (2) individually labeled reference images organized by disease class, and (3) optionally, the symptom descriptions from the disease registry (Section 4) together with an anatomical index that maps plant organs to the diseases that affect them. It also receives the full list of candidate disease classes and a reference budget k that limits how many reference images it may examine.

The agent follows a guided chain of thought. It first reads the test image and identifies the anatomical context (leaf, stem, root, seed) and visible symptoms: color changes, lesion shape, texture, and spatial patterns. If the knowledge base is available, the agent consults the **anatomical index** to narrow candidates to only those diseases that affect the observed organ, then reviews symptom descriptions to further prioritize. It then views reference images **one at a time**, comparing the test image against each labeled example and reasoning about what matches and what does not before selecting the next reference to examine. This sequential, deliberative comparison ensures the agent explores multiple candidates rather than confirming an initial guess. The agent concludes by producing a structured prediction with a brief explanation of its reasoning. The full system and user prompt is given in Appendix E.

The full sequence of the agent's actions and reasoning is captured as a **trace**. Each trace records which reference images the agent chose to view, the text it produced between views, and its final prediction. These traces are the primary vehicle for explainability: they allow a user to see not just

Table 2. Diagnostic accuracy across crops, methods, and reference budgets k (Sonnet model). Parentheses in the Crop column denote number of disease classes. The baseline is Agent (no KB) at k=0. Values show accuracy % with improvement over the per-crop baseline in parentheses. Best per crop-k in **bold**. Bottom rows show mean improvement (pp) over baseline, averaged across crops.

Crop	Method	$k=0$	$k=1$	$k=4$	$k=8$
Soybean (25)	Agent (no KB)	31.1% (+0.0)	40.5% (+9.5)	37.8% (+6.8)	45.9% (+14.9)
	Agent + internet KB	**45.2% (+14.1)**	**41.9% (+10.8)**	**48.6% (+17.6)**	**48.6% (+17.6)**
Corn (30)	Agent (no KB)	42.0% (+0.0)	43.2% (+1.1)	46.6% (+4.5)	52.3% (+10.2)
	Agent + internet KB	**51.1% (+9.1)**	**52.3% (+10.2)**	**60.2% (+18.2)**	**60.2% (+18.2)**
Tomato (20)	Agent (no KB)	**52.3% (+0.0)**	**54.5% (+2.3)**	61.4% (+9.1)	67.0% (+14.8)
	Agent + internet KB	**52.3% (+0.0)**	**54.5% (+2.3)**	**64.8% (+12.5)**	**76.1% (+23.9)**
Mango (4)	Agent (no KB)	**92.5% (+0.0)**	85.0% (-7.5)	**92.5% (+0.0)**	92.5% (+0.0)
	Agent + internet KB	87.5% (-5.0)	**97.5% (+5.0)**	**92.5% (+0.0)**	**97.5% (+5.0)**
Mean Δ (pp)	*Agent (no KB)*	+0.0	+1.3	+5.1	+10.0
	Agent + internet KB	+4.5	+7.1	+12.1	+16.2

what the system predicted but how it arrived at that prediction, which references it found most informative, and what alternative diagnoses it considered and ruled out. This stands in contrast to single-pass classification, where the model produces a label with no visibility into the decision process. Representative traces, including a soybean test image at k=8 with internet KB, are provided in Appendix I.

6. Experiments

We evaluate on four crops of varying difficulty—Soybean (25 classes), Corn (30), Tomato (20), Mango (4)—with 3 test images per class (5 for Tomato, 10 for Mango; fixed seed; counts in Appendix A). We vary the reference budget $k \in \{0, 1, 4, 8\}$, the KB source (none or internet), and the model tier (Haiku, Sonnet, Opus); the baseline is the k=0 agent with no KB (test image and candidate class names only).

Table 2 reports the main results. At k=0 the KB alone adds 14.1 pp on Soybean (31.1→45.2%) and 9.1 pp on Corn (42.0→51.1%); with more references accuracy rises further (Tomato 76.1%, Corn 60.2% at k=8 with KB; per-crop curves in Appendix F). *The full pipeline (KB, k=8) improves on the no-KB k=0 baseline by 16.2 percentage points on average across the four crops.* Figure 5 summarizes the per-crop KB effect across all budgets: consistent gains on Soybean, Corn, and Tomato, v

Figure 6 shows the cost–accuracy tradeoff: larger k improves accuracy at growing cost, and model quality is a complementary lever—at k=8, Opus exceeds Sonnet at comparable cost, while Haiku is cheapest but substantially less accurate.

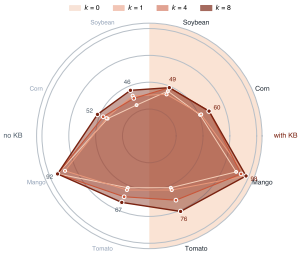


Figure 5. Per-crop accuracy across reference budgets. Right semicircle = with internet KB; left = no KB. Concentric polygons (light to dark) correspond to $k = 0, 1, 4, 8$.

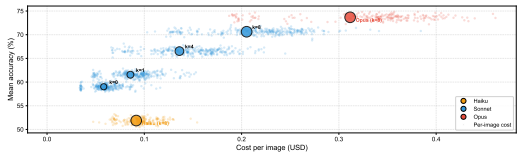


Figure 6. Cost-accuracy tradeoff (mean accuracy across all four crops, internet KB). Small dots show individual per-image API costs; large bubbles show aggregate means with bubble size proportional to reference budget k. Haiku and Opus shown at k=8. Cost estimates aggregated from Soybean, Corn, and Mango.

Figure 7 (Conclusion) shows Soybean confusion matrices: the baseline heavily over-predicts Sudden_death_syndrome, which the full pipeline reduces by using KB symptoms and reference comparisons to separate visually similar diseases. *Limitations of this work—KB dependence on class count, per-image inference cost, English-language KB sourcing, and reliance on the Claude API ecosystem—are discussed in Appendix H.*

7. Conclusion and Broader Impact

The agent improves over the baseline on all four crops; the KB contributes most at low reference budgets (KB alone: +14.1 pp Soybean, +9.1 pp Corn at k=0), and on Tomato KB and references compound (76.1% vs. 67.0% at k=8). Model quality is the highest-impact factor—upgrading the model beats adding a KB or more references—so *the system improves automatically as foundation models improve, with no retraining required.*

Against a single-pass few-shot baseline (Appendix Table 6), the agent wins at matched k and, unlike that black box, accompanies every prediction with an auditable reasoning trace. Together, the dataset, the source-cited registry, and the training-free agentic loop show that scalable plant disease diagnosis is possible without per-crop supervised training and with full visibility into each decision.

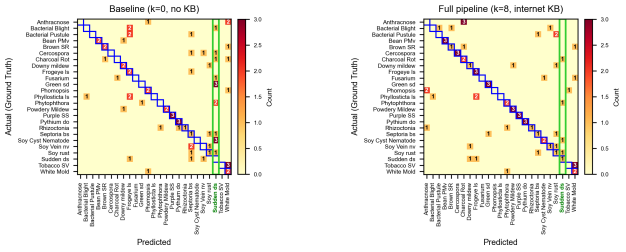


Figure 7. Confusion matrices for Soybean (Sonnet, 25 classes). Left: baseline, k=0, no KB (31.1%). Right: full pipeline, k=8, internet KB (48.6%). The highlighted Sudden_death_syndrome column shows over-prediction reduced as the agent uses KB symptoms and reference comparisons to distinguish visually similar diseases.

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Wong, and Tao Fang. Agri-cpj: A training-free explainable framework for agricultural pest diagnosis using caption-prompt-judge and llm-as-a-judge. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2604.23701*, 2026. 2

A. Evaluation Test-Set Sizes

Section 6 states the target per-class counts; the table below adds the realized post-filter range. Some classes ended below the target because KB-guided filtering rejected images whose visual content did not match the documented symptoms.

Crop	Classes	Total test images	Per class
Soybean	25	74	2–3 (avg 3.0)
Corn	30	88	2–3 (avg 2.9)
Tomato	20	88	3–5 (avg 4.6)
Mango	4	40	10

Table 3. Number of test images evaluated per class for each crop. Some classes had fewer than the target after KB-guided filtering rejected off-target images, hence the ranges.

B. Dataset Licenses

The SAGE collection is built from sources covering a mix of permissive and restricted licenses. The majority allow redistribution under attribution (CC BY 4.0, CC BY-SA 3.0, MIT, Apache 2.0); a smaller set carries non-commercial restrictions (CC BY-NC 3.0, CC BY-NC-ND 4.0) which we honor by linking to original hosts rather than mirroring. Bugwood imagery uses per-image attribution preserved in our metadata, and the World Bank rice subset follows the World Bank Dataset Terms of Use.

Table 4. Dataset license summary: hosting and distribution rights. Each row lists the license and citation requirements for datasets included in our collection.

Dataset	License	Notes & Citation
		Continued on next page
SBRD — Rice Leaf Diseases	World Bank ToU	World Bank Dataset Terms of Use apply; review before redistribution. Cite: Ethy, P.K., Barpanda et al. (2020); Ritharson, Kaggle, 2021.
MangoLeafBD — Mango Leaf Disease	CC BY-NC 3.0	Attribution required; non-commercial use only. Ahmed et al., *Data in Brief* 47, 2023. DOI: 10.1016/j.dib.2023.108941.
Bean Leaf Lesions Classification	Apache 2.0	Attribution required; include original license text. Marquis03, Kaggle.
YellowRust19 — Yellow Rust in Wheat	Default license (Kaggle ToS)	Default Kaggle license applies; contact author before redistribution. Cite: T. Hayit, *YellowRust19*, Kaggle, 2020.
Banana Leaf Disease Dataset v1.1	No explicit license	Compiled from three Kaggle datasets (rayhanarlistya, shifatearman, sujaykapadnis); cite all original creators.
Cauliflower Disease Multi Transformation	MIT	Attribution required; include original MIT license text. Shuvo Kumar Basak, Kaggle.
Lettuce Diseases Dataset	Apache 2.0	Attribution required; include LICENSE and NOTICE file. Ashish Jena, Kaggle.
Cucumber Plant Diseases Dataset	Default license (Kaggle ToS)	Default Kaggle license applies; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Karim Negm (`kareem3egm`), *Cucumber Plant Diseases Dataset*, Kaggle, 2020.
Durian Leaf Disease Dataset	CC BY 4.0	Attribution required. Cthng123, Kaggle.
Eggplant Disease Recognition Dataset	CC BY 4.0	Canonical Mendeley source (DOI: 10.17632/r3tb5mzn4d.2) confirmed CC BY 4.0. Mafi & Ava, 2023.
Cotton Disease Multi Transformation	MIT	Attribution required; include original MIT license text. Shuvo Kumar Basak, Kaggle.
Pumpkin Leaf Disease Multi Transformation	MIT	Attribution required; include original MIT license text. Shuvo Kumar Basak, Kaggle.
Rose Leaf Disease Multi Transformation	MIT	Attribution required; include original MIT license text. Shuvo Kumar Basak, Kaggle.
Coconut Disease Multi Transformation STTV	MIT	Attribution required; include original MIT license text. Shuvo Kumar Basak, Kaggle.
Vanilla Plant Disease Image Dataset	Default license (Kaggle ToS)	Default Kaggle license applies; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Muhammad Ihsan Permana (`mihsanpermana`), *Vanilla Plant Disease Image Dataset*, Kaggle, 2024.
Strawberry Disease Detection Dataset	Default license (permissive)	Default Kaggle license; description grants permission to use, modify, and augment. Cite: Afzaal et al., *Sensors* 21, 6565 (2021).
SugarLeafIDN — Sugarcane Leaf Diseases	Apache 2.0	Attribution required; include LICENSE and NOTICE file. Betty D. Puspasari, Kaggle.
Cucumber Disease and Freshness (Zenodo)	CC BY 4.0	Attribution required. Cite: *Cucumber Disease and Freshness Classification Dataset — Curated Annotations*, Zenodo, 2025. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.16816441.
New Plant Diseases Dataset (Augmented)	Default license (Kaggle ToS)	Default Kaggle license applies; augmented derivative of PlantVillage — contact author before redistribution and also cite Hughes & Salathé (PlantVillage source). Cite: Vipoooool, *New Plant Diseases Dataset*, Kaggle, 2018.
FUSARIUM22 — Fusarium Wilt in Chickpea	Default license (Kaggle ToS)	Default Kaggle license applies; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Hayit et al., *Eur. J. Plant Pathol.* 168 (2024).
PlantDoc Dataset	CC BY 4.0	Attribution required. Singh et al., *ACM IKDD CoDS & COMAD*, 2020. DOI: 10.1145/3371158.3371196.
Rady Plant Diseases Image-Text Pairs	Default license (HuggingFace)	No explicit license declared on the HuggingFace dataset card; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Rady10, *Plant-Diseases-Image-Text-Pairs*, HuggingFace Datasets.
A2H0H0R1 Plant Disease (New)	Default license (HuggingFace)	No explicit license declared on the HuggingFace dataset card; contact author before redistribution. Cite: A2H0H0R1, *plant-disease-new*, HuggingFace Datasets.
Avinash Plant Disease Classification	Default license (HuggingFace)	No explicit license declared on the HuggingFace dataset card; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Avinashhm, *plant-disease-classification-complete*, HuggingFace Datasets.
Saketh Plant Disease	Default license (HuggingFace)	No explicit license declared on the HuggingFace dataset card; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Sakethdevx, *plant-disease-dataset*, HuggingFace Datasets.

Table 4 — continued

Dataset	License	Notes & Citation
VQA Plant-Disease (Merged)	Default license (HuggingFace)	No explicit license declared on the HuggingFace dataset card; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Raghavendrad60, *vqa_plant-disease-classification-merged-dataset*, HuggingFace Datasets.
BD Crop & Vegetable Plant Disease	Default license (HuggingFace)	No explicit license declared on the HuggingFace dataset card; contact author before redistribution. Cite: Saon110, *bd-crop-vegetable-plant-disease-dataset*, HuggingFace Datasets.
PlantVillage Dataset	CC BY-SA 3.0	Attribution + ShareAlike required; derivatives must carry the same license. Hughes & Salathé, arXiv:1511.08060, 2015.
LeafNet Dataset	CC BY 4.0	Confirmed CC BY 4.0 on HuggingFace (`enalis/LeafNet`); ∼70% of data is public (training split only). Quoc et al., arXiv:2602.13662, 2026.
Soybean Stress Identification (PNAS)	CC BY 4.0	Attribution required. Ghosal et al., *PNAS* 115(18), 4613–4618, 2018. DOI: 10.1073/pnas.1716999115.
PlantWild v2 Dataset	CC BY-NC-ND 4.0	No commercial use; no derivatives permitted. Wei et al., *ACM MM*, 2024. DOI: 10.1145/3664647.3680599.
CDDM — Crop Disease Domain Multimodal	CC BY-NC-ND 4.0	No commercial use; no derivatives permitted. Liu et al., arXiv:2503.06973, 2025.
Bugwood Image Database	Per-image attribution (Bugwood ToU)	Image rights remain with the individual photographers/contributors; attribution and Bugwood acknowledgement required for each image used. Cite: The Bugwood Network, *Bugwood Image Database System*, Center for Invasive Species and Ecosystem Health, University of Georgia.

C. Splits and Image Filtering

Because images are aggregated from many sources, the same disease often appears under several different class names (e.g., “Leaf_Rust”, “leaf rust”, and “rust_disease” across three sources). Before any automated filtering, domain experts have reviewed the union of class labels across sources and merge variants that refer to the same disease, producing a single canonical class per disease. After this dedupe step, raw image collections still contain noise: mislabeled images, images showing healthy tissue, or images where the disease presentation does not match the documented symptoms. We filter images using the disease registry as ground truth. For each image in a class, a vision-language model receives the image alongside the knowledge base (KB) symptom description for that class and determines whether the image is consistent with the description. Matched images are kept; mismatches are rejected.

During filtering, each matched image is also tagged with its *anatomical context*: the primary plant organ visible (leaf, stem, root, seed, pod, or whole plant). This produces an anatomical index that maps each organ to the set of diseases that affect it, enabling the agent to narrow candidates at inference based on the organ visible in the test image. Figure 1 (Curation, top row) illustrates this filtering and tagging process.

Matched images are split into reference and test sets. Reference images are organized by class and organ; test images are held out for evaluation. For the four evaluation crops, this yields Soybean (25 classes, 74 test images), Corn (30 classes, 88 test images), Tomato (20 classes, 88 test images), and Mango (4 classes, 40 test images).

D. Registry Schema

Every entry in the released registry conforms to the schema below. Each non-identifier field is stored as a triple of `{value, source_url, verbatim_quote}` so that any claim can be traced back to a specific passage on a specific page. This is what makes the expert audit step (Section 4) tractable: a reviewer reads the quote next to the claim and judges whether the source actually supports it. It also lets downstream users and reviewers re-verify any field at any time without re-running the pipeline.

An agronomist audited the registry field by field for five crops, marking each claim as agreement, disagreement, or unsure. Agreement is highest on host-organ and pathogen-type claims, which are factual and easy to verify; the bulk of disagreement concentrates in fine-grained visual symptom claims where source pages either conflate disease stages or describe symptoms in ways that do not transfer to a single image. The 70–90% agreement range across crops is the headline evidence that the source-grounded extraction is faithful enough to ship to the agent without manual rewriting.

Field	Example
Crop (host)	Soybean
Disease	White mold (Sclerotinia Stem Rot)
Pathogen	*Sclerotinia sclerotiorum*
Pathogen type	Fungal
Affected organs	Stem, seed
Visual symptoms	lesion shape, color, texture, . . .

Table 5. Registry schema. Each field carries per-field provenance: the extracted value, the source URL, and a verbatim supporting quote.

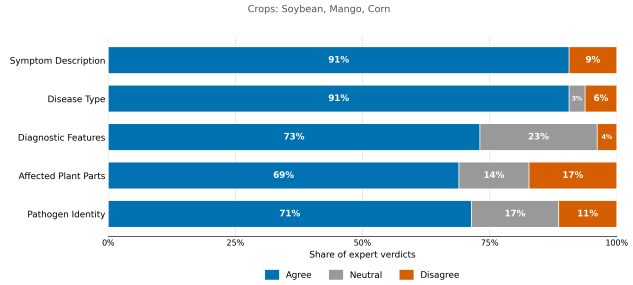


Figure 8. Expert agronomist verdicts on KB-sourced claims across five crops (soybean, mango, banana, sugarcane, corn). Agreement ranges from 70% to 90%, with disagreement at or below 16%.

E. Agent Prompt

The agent is driven by the system prompt below, shown for the canonical full-feature configuration (reference budget $k \geq 8$, KB present, part index present). Placeholders in angle brackets are filled at runtime; lower-budget and KB-free runs adjust steps 2–5 accordingly.

```
You are an expert plant pathologist classifying a diseased plant image.

## Strategy
1. Read the test image first. Note the affected plant part
   (leaf, stem, pod, root, whole plant) and key visual features
   (color, shape, pattern, texture).
2. Read the part index file `<PART_INDEX_PATH>` and find the plant
   part you identified. This narrows the candidate classes to only
   those that affect that part. Focus on these candidates. Stay
   within the part-narrowed set. Only view classes outside it if
   you have exhausted all candidates within it and still have budget.
3. Review the symptom descriptions below to narrow further.
4. View reference images one at a time. Read ONE image, analyze how
   it compares to the test image, then decide which class to check
   next. Do NOT read multiple images in parallel. Explore before
   confirming: view one reference from EACH of your top candidates
   before viewing a second from any class.
5. IMPORTANT: Make your final prediction based on VISUAL SIMILARITY
   to reference images, not KB descriptions. The symptom descriptions
   help you understand what to look for, but when deciding between
   candidates, the reference image that most closely matches the test
   image wins. Do NOT let a text description override what you see in
   the images.
- Submit your prediction.

End your response with exactly this JSON block:
```json
{"prediction": "<class_name>", "confidence": <0.0-1.0>,
 "reasoning": "<brief explanation>"}
```
The prediction MUST be one of the provided class names (exact match).
```

The accompanying user message provides the test image path, the full list of candidate class names, the per-class reference image paths with the explicit budget instruction, and the symptom KB in markdown:

```
## Test Image

Read this file to see the image you need to classify:
`<TEST_IMAGE_PATH>`

## Possible Classes (<N> total)

- <class_1>
- <class_2>
- ...

## Reference Images (Budget: exactly **<k>** reference image views.
You MUST use all <k> views before submitting. Spread across at least
**<min_classes>** different classes (1 per class first, then revisit
```

```
if budget remains).)

<total_refs> reference images. Use the Read tool to view them:
- **<class_1>**: `<path_1>`, `<path_2>`
- **<class_2>**: `<path>`
- ...

## Symptom Descriptions (Knowledge Base)

<KB markdown: per-disease symptom summary, diagnostic features,
look-alikes, with verbatim source quotes>

Now begin: Read the test image, reason through the evidence,
and end with your prediction JSON.
```

The exact prompt-construction code is released with the codebase at https://sage-dataset.github.io/ (open_agentic/prompt.py).

F. Per-Crop Accuracy Curves

Per-crop accuracy as the reference budget k varies, with and without the internet KB (Sonnet). The split-radar in Section 6 compresses the same data into a single panel; this view makes the per-k trajectory explicit.

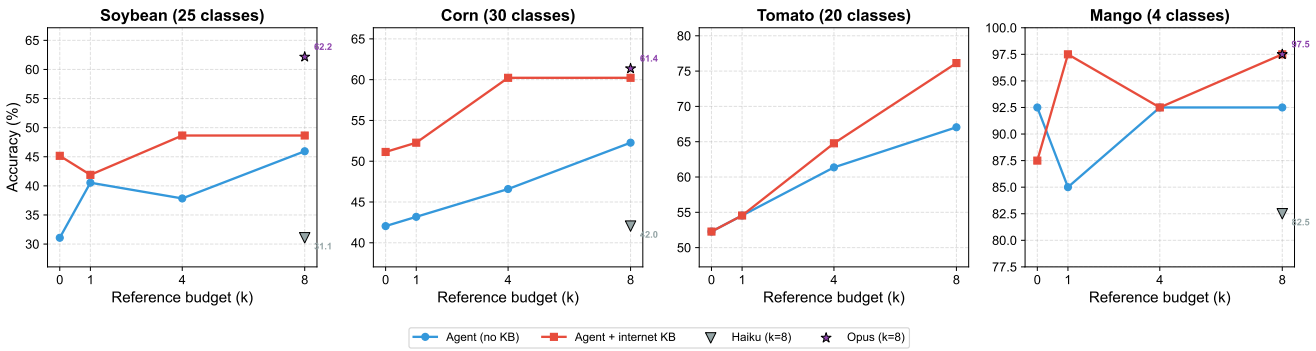


Figure 9. Diagnostic accuracy vs. reference budget k across four crops. Each panel shows the agent with no KB (blue) and with internet KB (red).

G. Few-Shot Comparison

Table 6 compares the agentic pipeline against a single-pass few-shot baseline, as discussed in Section 7. The table covers three crops (Soybean, Corn, Mango); few-shot was not run on Tomato.

Few-shot reaches at most $+8.1$ pp at $k{=}8$ averaged across these three crops, well below the agentic pipeline's gain at the same budget on the same crops.

H. Limitations

The KB benefit depends on class count. On Mango (4 classes) the agent saturates near ceiling regardless of KB; on Soybean and Corn (25 and 30 classes) the KB carries most of the early-budget gain. Visual similarity alone is largely sufficient at small class counts. Per-image inference cost (Figure 6) is the other practical limit: Sonnet at $k{=}8$ averages \$0.21 per image and Opus roughly doubles that, which is workable for high-value uses such as extension scouting or breeding pipelines, less so for routine smartphone-scale field deployment. The registry is built from English-language web pages and extension materials, so crops documented mainly in other languages will produce a thinner KB.

We currently rely on the Claude API ecosystem because it supports programmatic agentic loops at the scale we evaluate; we expect this ecosystem to mature, and to reduce risk we test on all three model tiers (Haiku, Sonnet, Opus) so the trends are not tied to a single model. We see the dataset and registry pipeline as the durable contribution; extending evaluation (more crops, models, seeds) and agent design (cheaper inference, multi-disease handling, stage-aware symptoms) are natural next steps.

Table 6. Single-pass few-shot classification accuracy. The model receives k randomly sampled labeled images in a single API call with no reasoning loop (Sonnet, 3 test images per class). Baseline is Agent (no KB) at k=0. Best per crop–k in **bold**.

Crop	$k = 0$	$k = 1$	$k = 4$	$k = 8$
Soybean	41.9% (+10.8)	41.9% (+10.8)	40.5% (+9.5)	**47.3% (+16.2)**
Corn	42.0% (+0.0)	38.6% (-3.4)	48.9% (+6.8)	**50.0% (+8.0)**
Mango	92.5% (+0.0)	**95.0% (+2.5)**	92.5% (+0.0)	92.5% (+0.0)
Mean Δ (pp)	*+3.6*	*+3.3*	*+5.4*	*+8.1*

I. Extended Reasoning Traces

The following traces show the agent's step-by-step reasoning across different crops, KB sources, models, and reference budgets. Each trace includes the configuration, the agent's observations and comparisons, and the final prediction with outcome. The traces collectively illustrate KB-guided narrowing on success cases as well as failure modes where visual ambiguity overrode KB evidence.

We begin with a representative trace on a soybean test image at k=8 with internet KB.

Reasoning Trace: Soybean Diseases — Frogeye_leaf_spot__Soybean_Dise_21



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Frogeye_leaf_spot
Ground truth: Frogeye_leaf_spot
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.93

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows a soybean leaf with small, circular lesions having gray/tan centers and distinct reddish-brown margins. This pattern is very characteristic of Frogeye leaf spot. Let me check the part index and confirm with reference images.

Step 3: `View reference: part_index`

Step 4: Leaf is the affected part. Top candidates: Frogeye_leaf_spot (gray centers, reddish-brown borders), Septoria_brown_spot, Phyllosticta_leaf_spot. Let me check references.

Step 5: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_6`

Step 6: Strong match - circular lesions with reddish-brown borders. Now checking 7 more different classes.

Step 7: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_12`

Step 8: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_18`

Step 9: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_17`

Step 10: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_74`

Step 11: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_93`

Step 12: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_137`

Step 13: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_62`

Step 14: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_39`

Step 15: All 8 views used. The analysis is clear:

- Test image: Small circular lesions (5-10mm), gray/tan centers, distinct reddish-brown margins, scattered on green leaf - Frogeye_leaf_spot reference: Near-identical match - same circular morphology, same gray centers with reddish-brown borders - All other candidates: Don't match - Septoria shows irregular dark lesions with yellowing; Rust shows tiny numerous specks; Cercospora shows diffuse bronze discoloration; Bacterial Blight shows angular yellow-haloed lesions; SDS shows interveinal chlorosis; Downy mildew shows pale yellow patches; Bacterial Pustule shows confluent dark blotches

Reasoning Trace: Soybean Diseases — Bacterial_Blight__Soybean_Dise_125



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Bacterial_Blight
Ground truth: Bacterial_Blight
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.82

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows a soybean leaf with dark brown/black irregular lesions surrounded by yellow/chlorotic halos. The lesions appear angular and concentrated along the mid-vein area. The green tissue between lesions remains intact.

Top candidates: Bacterial_Blight (angular lesions + yellow halos), Septoria_brown_spot (dark irregular lesions), Soybean_Vein_necrosis_virus (lesions along veins with yellow tissue).

Now I'll view one reference from each top candidate.

Step 3: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_17`

Step 4: This Bacterial_Blight reference matches well - dark irregular lesions with yellow-green halos. Let me check Septoria_brown_spot next.

Step 5: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_12`

Step 6: Septoria shows extensive yellowing with small dark spots - different from the test image which has a mostly green leaf with distinct dark lesions and yellow halos. Let me check Soybean_Vein_necrosis_virus.

Step 7: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_126`

Step 8: Vein necrosis shows diffuse yellow spots without clear dark lesion centers - doesn't match. I need one more class view. The dark lesions with yellow halos in the test image best match Bacterial_Blight so far. Let me check Frogeye_leaf_spot as my 4th class.

Step 9: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_6`

Step 10: Analysis summary:

- Test image: Green soybean leaf with dark brown/black irregular lesions surrounded by yellow-green halos, concentrated along the mid-vein. - Bacterial_Blight reference: Nearly identical - dark angular lesions with yellow-green halos on green leaf. Best match. - Septoria_brown_spot: Extensive yellowing with tiny dark spots - doesn't match (test leaf is mostly green). - Soybean_Vein_necrosis_virus: Diffuse yellowish spots without distinct dark centers - doesn't match. - Frogeye_leaf_spot: Small circular lesions with holes, reddish-brown borders - doesn't match the larger irregular pattern.

The yellow-green halos + dark angular/irregular lesions on an otherwise green leaf is the hallmark of Bacterial_Blight.

Reasoning Trace: Soybean Diseases — Anthracnose__Soybean_Dise_10



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Charcoal_Rot
Ground truth: Anthracnose
Outcome: **Incorrect**
Confidence: 0.88

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: Key observations from the test image: - Plant part: Stem (3 stems shown close-up) - Key features: Bleached/pale white-tan stems with numerous small black specks scattered across the surface - Texture: Fluffy/hairy white mycelial growth visible on stems - Black structures: Many small black bodies embedded in/on the white bleached stem tissue

The white bleached stems + black sclerotia embedded in white mycelium is classic White Mold. Let me verify with reference images, then also check Charcoal Rot (which has black microsclerotia under the epidermis) as a candidate.

Step 3: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_339`

Step 4: This White Mold reference shows early-stage large sclerotia but the stem is still green. Let me check Charcoal Rot to compare the black speck pattern.

Step 5: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_108`

Step 6: Charcoal Rot shows a pale stem but without the dense black specks pattern. Now let me check the other White Mold stem image.

Step 7: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_56`

Step 8: Both White Mold references show bleached stems with black structures, but the test image has very dense, numerous tiny black specks — more consistent with microsclerotia. Let me use my last view on Charcoal Rot to compare.

Step 9: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_49`

Step 10: This is a strong match. The Charcoal Rot reference (Soybean_Dise_49) shows exactly the same pattern as the test image: - Multiple stems shown together - Pale/bleached tan-gray stems - Dense, numerous tiny black specks scattered across the stem surface (microsclerotia giving the "charcoal-sprinkled" appearance) - The internal split stem shows white pith

This matches the test image almost perfectly — three stems displayed, pale/bleached with countless tiny black dots (microsclerotia) across the surface. White Mold sclerotia are larger and fewer; what's visible here is the characteristic microsclerotia of Charcoal Rot.

Reasoning Trace: Soybean Diseases — Bacterial_Blight__Soybean_Dise_125



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: no KB
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Bacterial_Blight
Ground truth: Bacterial_Blight
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.87

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows a soybean leaf with dark brown/purplish-black lesions surrounded by yellow halos, distributed along the leaf midrib area. There's also one hole. The yellow halo + dark center pattern strongly suggests bacterial or fungal leaf spotting.

Top candidates: Bacterial_Blight (angular dark lesions + yellow halos), Septoria_brown_spot, Cercospora, Frogeye_leaf_spot.

Now viewing one reference from each of my 4 top candidates:

Step 3: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_17`

Step 4: This Bacterial_Blight reference matches very well - dark brown/purple lesions with yellow halos. Now checking Septoria and Cercospora.

Step 5: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_12`

Step 6: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_33`

Step 7: The Cercospora reference shows seed discoloration - completely different from the test image. The Bacterial_Blight reference is a clear match.

Analysis: - Test image: soybean leaf with dark brown/purple lesions + prominent yellow halos, angular distribution along midrib - Bacterial_Blight reference: identical pattern - dark lesions with yellow halos on green leaf tissue - Septoria_brown_spot: more extensive yellowing, smaller spots scattered throughout - Cercospora: seed discoloration, not leaf lesions

The yellow halo + dark angular lesion pattern is the defining feature of Bacterial_Blight.

Reasoning Trace: Soybean Diseases — Anthracnose__Soybean_Dise_10



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: no KB
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Phomopsis
Ground truth: Anthracnose
Outcome: Incorrect
Confidence: 0.62

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows soybean stems with pale/bleached (cream-white) coloration and scattered small black dots across the stem surface. These are likely pycnidia or microsclerotia. Candidates: Phomopsis (bleached stems + black pycnidia), Charcoal_Rot (gray stem + black microsclerotia), Anthracnose (dark lesions + black acervuli).

Now viewing one reference from each top candidate:

Step 3: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_14`

Step 4: This Phomopsis image shows a pod. Let me check Charcoal_Rot and Anthracnose references.

Step 5: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_10`

Step 6: Let me use my last view on another Charcoal_Rot reference showing the stem close-up:

Step 7: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_52`

Step 8: Visual analysis of the test image: - 3 soybean stems shown close-up - Stems are pale/cream/bleached white - Numerous small black dots scattered across the stem surface - Top stem is more brownish (earlier stage?), middle and bottom stems are distinctly bleached

Reasoning: The characteristic pale/cream bleached stems with scattered black pycnidia (fruiting bodies) visible on the surface is classic Phomopsis stem blight. The bleaching pattern and black dot distribution match this disease. Charcoal_Rot was also considered (microsclerotia + silvery-gray stem), but Charcoal_Rot typically shows more grayish discoloration rather than this cream/white bleaching. The reference Charcoal_Rot images also showed field-level wilting symptoms rather than close-up stem bleaching with black dots.

Reasoning Trace: Soybean Diseases — Bacterial_Blight__Soybean_Dise_125



Test image

Model: opus
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Bacterial_Blight
Ground truth: Bacterial_Blight
Outcome: Correct
Confidence: 0.92

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: `View reference: part_index`

Step 3: The test image shows a soybean leaf with dark brown irregular lesions concentrated in a band, surrounded by yellowish-green halos. Some tissue has fallen out leaving holes, giving a ragged appearance. Lesions appear somewhat angular.

This is a leaf disease. Top candidates based on symptoms: Bacterial_Blight, Septoria_brown_spot, Soybean_Vein_necrosis_virus, Bacterial_Pustule. Let me view references across 8 classes.

Step 4: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_17`

Step 5: Bacterial_Blight reference shows angular brown spots with yellow halos, merged dead patches. Very similar pattern to test image. Let me check other candidates.

Step 6: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_12`

Step 7: Septoria brown spot shows numerous small dark spots with extensive leaf yellowing. Different pattern from the test image. Let me continue.

Step 8: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_126`

Step 9: SVN shows yellow spots along veins, different from the test image's angular merged lesions with halos. Let me check more.

Step 10: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_11`

Step 11: Bacterial Pustule reference shows a close-up of severely affected leaf tissue with extensive brown/orange discoloration. Very different from the test image. Let me check more classes.

Step 12: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_6`

Step 13: Frogeye leaf spot shows discrete circular gray spots with reddish-brown borders, scattered across the leaf. Very different from the test image's merged angular lesions. Let me continue.

Step 14: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_137`

Step 15: Downy mildew shows light yellow spots spread across the leaf surface. Very different from the test image. Let me check two more classes.

Step 16: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_74`

Step 17: Soybean rust shows small tan to brick-red spots scattered across the leaf. Very different from the test image. One more class to check.

Step 18: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_18`

Step 19: Phyllosticta shows large tan lesions with dark margins, different pattern from the test image.

I've now viewed 8 references across 8 different classes. The evidence strongly points to Bacterial_Blight:

- Angular, vein-limited brown lesions matching the description perfectly - Yellowish-green halos surrounding the darkened spots - Merged dead patches where spots have coalesced - Tissue falling out leaving holes, creating the characteristic "ragged appearance" - The Bacterial_Blight reference image showed the most similar pattern

No other class matched: Septoria had extensive yellowing with small scattered spots, Frogeye had discrete circular gray-centered spots, Downy mildew/Soybean rust had very different spot patterns, and Phyllosticta had larger irregular tan lesions.

Reasoning Trace: Soybean Diseases — Anthracnose__Soybean_Dise_10



Test image

Model: opus
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Charcoal_Rot
Ground truth: Anthracnose
Outcome: **Incorrect**
Confidence: 0.92

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: `View reference: part_index`

Step 3: The test image shows soybean stems with numerous small black specks/dots scattered across bleached/tan stem surfaces. This narrows candidates to stem diseases.

Top candidates based on symptoms: - Charcoal_Rot: microsclerotia giving "charcoal-sprinkled" appearance - Anthracnose: black acervuli with setae on stems

Let me view references systematically, one at a time.

Step 4: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_108`

Step 5: Charcoal rot reference shows gray streaks but not the dense black specks pattern in the test image. Let me check Anthracnose.

Step 6: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_17`

Step 7: Anthracnose shows dark lesions on stems with pods attached. Let me check the other Charcoal Rot stem reference.

Step 8: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_49`

Step 9: This Charcoal Rot reference is a strong match - small black specks (microsclerotia) scattered on gray/tan stems, very similar to the test image. Let me check other stem disease candidates for comparison.

Step 10: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_339`

Step 11: White Mold shows fluffy white mycelium and large black sclerotia - doesn't match. Let me check Anthracnose stem more closely and other candidates.

Step 12: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_67`

Step 13: Anthracnose on green stems with pods - different stage and appearance. Let me check Phytophthora stem and Rhizoctonia stem.

Step 14: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_57`

Step 15: Phytophthora shows dark chocolate-brown stem discoloration on living plants - doesn't match. Let me check Rhizoctonia and Fusarium stems.

Step 16: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_18`

Step 17: Rhizoctonia shows sunken lesions at the soil line on seedlings - doesn't match.

Step 18: `View reference: Soybean_Dise_54`

Step 19: Fusarium shows discolored roots/stems on seedlings - doesn't match.

All 8 reference views used. The evidence strongly points to Charcoal Rot:

- Test image: Mature, dry soybean stems with dense, small black specks scattered across a gray/tan stem surface - Charcoal Rot reference (Dise_49): Nearly identical pattern of small black microsclerotia on gray stems - Symptom description match: "small black specks (microsclerotia) beneath the epidermis giving a charcoal-sprinkled appearance" matches perfectly - Other candidates eliminated: Anthracnose (different fruiting body pattern), White Mold (fluffy mycelium + large sclerotia), Phytophthora (chocolate-brown discoloration on living stems), Rhizoctonia (soil-line lesions), Fusarium (seedling stage)

Reasoning Trace: Corn Diseases — Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback__Corn_Disease_47

Model: sonnet
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback
Ground truth: Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.42



Test image

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: `View reference: part_index`

Step 3: The test image shows corn stalks with very dark blackish/bluish-black discoloration, particularly on the rind, with yellowish areas near nodes. This is a stem specimen. Stem candidates: Anthracnose, Bacterial_Stalk_Rot, Charcoal_Stalk_Rot, Diplodia_Stalk_Rot, Physoderma_Stalk_Rot, Purple_Leaf_Sheath.

The dark blackish nodes are striking. Top candidates: Physoderma_Stalk_Rot (black nodes), Anthracnose (black shiny stalk), Charcoal_Stalk_Rot (charred interior), Diplodia_Stalk_Rot. Let me view one reference per top candidate.

Step 4: `View reference: Corn_Disease_17`

Step 5: `View reference: Corn_Disease_12`

Step 6: `View reference: Corn_Disease_10`

Step 7: `View reference: Corn_Disease_2`

Step 8: Test image analysis: - Affected part: stem (stalk sections cut and laid on wooden planks) - Key features: extensive deep blue-black discoloration across the entire stalk rind, yellowish-tan coloring at nodes, multiple stalk sections

Reference comparison: 1. Physoderma_Stalk_Rot — reference shows localized dark spots on green stalk. Doesn't match the extensive rind blackening. 2. Charcoal_Stalk_Rot — reference shows dark shredded interior with charred pith. Interior charring doesn't match the exterior rind blackening in the test image. 3. Anthracnose (stem) — reference shows brownish-black patches on rind with some rotted sections. Closer match — Anthracnose stalk rot is known for extensive black discoloration of the stalk rind. 4. Purple_Leaf_Sheath — reference shows localized dark lesion on otherwise green stalk. Doesn't match.

The deep, extensive blue-black coloration of the entire stalk exterior rind, with yellowish nodes, is most consistent with Anthracnose stalk rot. The Anthracnose stalk phase causes characteristic shiny black lesions across the lower stalk rind — which aligns with what's visible.

Reasoning Trace: Corn Diseases — Aspergillus_Ear_Rot__Corn_Disease_19



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Fusarium_Disease
Ground truth: Aspergillus_Ear_Rot
Outcome: **Incorrect**
Confidence: 0.50

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: `View reference: part_index`

Step 3: The test image shows a corn ear with damage concentrated at the tip — brownish/reddish-pink rotted kernels at the tip, some whitish material mixed in, healthy yellow kernels below. This is a seed/pod part. Top candidates: Fusarium_Disease, Gibberella_Disease, Aspergillus_Ear_Rot, Diplodia_Ear_Rot.

Step 4: `View reference: Corn_Disease_25`

Step 5: `View reference: Corn_Disease_18`

Step 6: `View reference: Corn_Disease_15`

Step 7: `View reference: Corn_Disease_27`

Step 8: Analysis:

- Test image: Corn ear with tip rot — rotted/shriveled brownish-reddish-pink kernels concentrated at the tip, whitish material in the damaged area, insect damage visible, healthy yellow kernels below. - Fusarium_Disease ref: Whitish-pinkish mold scattered mid-ear — partial match (tip location fits, color fits partially). - Gibberella_Disease ref: Vivid red/pink mold starting at tip — the red color is more intense than the test image's brownish-pink. - Aspergillus_Ear_Rot ref: Olive-green powdery mold — no match. - Diplodia_Ear_Rot ref: White mycelium from base, bleached husks — no match.

Reasoning: The test image shows tip-concentrated rot with brownish-pinkish kernels and some whitish mold material. Fusarium is described as "whitish to pink-colored fungal growth on kernels, often at the ear tip" with association with insect damage entry points. The whitish material visible + tip location + pinkish-brownish coloration fits Fusarium better than the vivid red of Gibberella. Aspergillus and Diplodia are clearly ruled out.

Reasoning Trace: Corn Diseases — Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback__Corn_Disease_47



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: no KB
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback
Ground truth: Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.52

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows corn stalks laid out, with dark/black discoloration on the outer surface and yellow-tan internal tissue. This looks like a stalk rot disease. Key features: dark blackened exterior, yellowing/tan mixed tissue, stalks split open showing internal decay.

Candidates: Charcoal_Stalk_Rot, Diplodia_Stalk_Rot, Gibberella_Disease, Bacterial_Stalk_Rot, Physoderma_Stalk_Rot.

Let me view reference images one at a time.

Step 3: `View reference: Corn_Disease_12`

Step 4: `View reference: Corn_Disease_14`

Step 5: `View reference: Corn_Disease_17`

Step 6: `View reference: Corn_Disease_12`

Step 7: `View reference: Corn_Disease_16`

Step 8: `View reference: Corn_Disease_32`

Step 9: `View reference: Corn_Disease_10`

Step 10: `View reference: Corn_Disease_52`

Step 11: I've now viewed 8 reference images. Let me assess:

Test image features: Two corn stalks laid out on a wooden surface, showing heavy dark/black exterior discoloration with yellow-tan patches, one stalk split open revealing fibrous internal tissue. Classic stalk rot presentation.

Reference comparison: - Charcoal_Stalk_Rot (Corn_Disease_12, 32): Shows dark internal pith with gray-black sclerotia — internal focus, doesn't match the heavy black exterior - Diplodia_Stalk_Rot (Corn_Disease_14): Dry, tan/brown stalk breaking at node — no black exterior - Physoderma_Stalk_Rot (Corn_Disease_17): Dark spots on a green stalk — very different - Gibberella_Disease (Corn_Disease_12): Ear rot with pink/white mold — completely different - Bacterial_Stalk_Rot (Corn_Disease_16): Tan/brown leaf sheath discoloration — different - Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback (Corn_Disease_10): Shows stalks with brown/dark exterior patches including black areas at nodes — closer match. Anthracnose stalk rot is specifically known for causing shiny black discoloration of the outer stalk rind

The heavy black/dark exterior discoloration on the stalks is most consistent with Anthracnose stalk rot, which is part of the Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback complex. The Corn_Disease_10 reference showed similar dark stalk exterior features.

Reasoning Trace: Corn Diseases — Aspergillus_Ear_Rot__Corn_Disease_19



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: no KB
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Gibberella_Disease
Ground truth: Aspergillus_Ear_Rot
Outcome: **Incorrect**
Confidence: 0.82

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows a corn ear with rot concentrated at the tip. The affected kernels are brown/pinkish with some white-gray mold growth. The rest of the ear has healthy yellow kernels. This pattern suggests an ear rot disease — likely Gibberella (pink/red tip rot) or Fusarium.

Let me check reference images for top candidates.

Step 3: `View reference: Corn_Disease_12`

Step 4: `View reference: Corn_Disease_25`

Step 5: `View reference: Corn_Disease_27`

Step 6: `View reference: Corn_Disease_15`

Step 7: `View reference: Corn_Disease_42`

Step 8: `View reference: Corn_Disease_2`

Step 9: `View reference: Corn_Disease_42`

Step 10: `View reference: Corn_Disease_64`

Step 11: Analysis summary:

- Test image: Corn ear with tip-concentrated rot. Kernels at the tip are brownish/pinkish-discolored with white-gray mold. Lower ear has healthy yellow kernels.

Reference comparisons: - Gibberella_Disease (ref 12): Very strong match — same tip rot pattern, brownish-pink kernels, white mold growth concentrated at tip. - Gibberella_Disease (ref 42): Confirms tip-to-base progression pattern. - Gibberella_Disease (ref 64): Shows pink discoloration on husks, consistent with the disease. - Fusarium_Disease: Scattered patches across the ear, not tip-focused — does not match. - Diplodia_Ear_Rot: Different presentation (dried/bleached), no pink coloration. - Aspergillus_Ear_Rot: Distinctive olive-green mold — clearly different. - Trichoderma_Ear_Rot: Blue-green mold all over — clearly different.

The tip-origin rot with brownish-pink kernel discoloration and white mold is the hallmark of Gibberella ear rot. The visual match to the Gibberella reference (Corn_Disease_12.jpg) is strong.

Reasoning Trace: Corn Diseases — Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback__Corn_Disease_47



Test image

Model: opus
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback
Ground truth: Anthracnose_Leaf_Spot_And_Top_Dieback
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.95

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: `View reference: part_index`

Step 3: The test image shows corn stalks with dark black discoloration, particularly at the nodes. The stalks appear broken/split, exposing internal tissue. This is a stem disease.

Stem candidates: Anthracnose, Bacterial_Stalk_Rot, Charcoal_Stalk_Rot, Common_Smut, Diplodia_Stalk_Rot, Physoderma_Brown_Spot, Physoderma_Stalk_Rot, Purple_Leaf_Sheath, among others.

Top suspects based on symptoms: Physoderma_Stalk_Rot (black nodes, snapping), Charcoal_Stalk_Rot, Anthracnose (stem), Purple_Leaf_Sheath. Let me view references one at a time.

Step 4: `View reference: Corn_Disease_17`

Step 5: Physoderma Stalk Rot reference shows a green stalk with dark spots, quite different from the test image's dry, heavily blackened stalks. Let me check Charcoal_Stalk_Rot next.

Step 6: `View reference: Corn_Disease_12`

Step 7: Charcoal Stalk Rot shows shredded pith with dark interior. The external dark discoloration is somewhat similar. Let me check Anthracnose stem, Purple_Leaf_Sheath, and Diplodia_Stalk_Rot.

Step 8: `View reference: Corn_Disease_10`

Step 9: Anthracnose stem shows shiny black areas on the stalk exterior, similar to the test image. Let me check Purple_Leaf_Sheath and Diplodia_Stalk_Rot.

Step 10: `View reference: Corn_Disease_11`

Step 11: Purple_Leaf_Sheath shows a green, living plant with brown/dark lesions on the sheath. Very different from the test image's dry, dead stalks. Let me check Diplodia_Stalk_Rot.

Step 12: `View reference: Corn_Disease_14`

Step 13: Diplodia Stalk Rot shows tan/brown dry stalks, not the heavy black discoloration in the test image. Let me check Bacterial_Stalk_Rot and Common_Smut stem.

Step 14: `View reference: Corn_Disease_16`

Step 15: Bacterial Stalk Rot shows wilted, brown leaves on a still-standing plant. Not similar. Let me check Common_Smut stem and a second Anthracnose stem reference.

Step 16: `View reference: Corn_Disease_176`

Step 17: Common Smut shows galls, completely different. Let me view the second Anthracnose stem reference, which was the closest match so far.

Step 18: `View reference: Corn_Disease_60`

Step 19: This is a very strong match. The Anthracnose stem reference (Corn_Disease_60.jpg) shows the exact same presentation as the test image: dry corn stalks laid on wooden boards over rocks, with shiny black discoloration on the rind interspersed with tan/yellow areas, and exposed lighter internal tissue where the stalk is broken. The background, stalk appearance, and black lesion pattern are nearly identical.

Reasoning Trace: Corn Diseases — Aspergillus_Ear_Rot__Corn_Disease_19



Test image

Model: opus
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Fusarium_Disease
Ground truth: Aspergillus_Ear_Rot
Outcome: **Incorrect**
Confidence: 0.55

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: `View reference: part_index`

Step 3: The test image shows a corn ear with damage at the tip. Kernels at the tip are discolored, swollen, and some appear damaged with whitish material between them. The rest of the ear looks healthy. This is a seed/ear disease.

Candidates from the seed/pod categories: Aspergillus_Ear_Rot, Common_Smut, Diplodia_Ear_Rot, Fusarium_Disease, Gibberella_Disease, Trichoderma_Ear_Rot, Head_Smut.

Let me view reference images one per class, starting with top candidates.

Step 4: `View reference: Corn_Disease_25`

Step 5: Fusarium reference shows whitish mold on scattered kernels mid-ear. The test image has damage concentrated at the tip with swollen kernels. Let me check other candidates.

Step 6: `View reference: Corn_Disease_218`

Step 7: Common Smut shows large silvery-white galls. Not what's in the test image. Let me check more candidates.

Step 8: `View reference: Corn_Disease_15`

Step 9: Aspergillus shows olive-green powdery mold. Not matching. Let me check Diplodia, Gibberella, Trichoderma, and Head_Smut.

Step 10: `View reference: Corn_Disease_41`

Step 11: Diplodia shows cross-section with grayish-brown rotted kernels. Not matching the test image pattern. Let me check Gibberella.

Step 12: `View reference: Corn_Disease_18`

Step 13: Gibberella shows pinkish mold at ear tip. The test image doesn't have pink coloration. Let me check Trichoderma and Head_Smut.

Step 14: `View reference: Corn_Disease_26`

Step 15: Trichoderma shows dark blue-green conidia. Not matching. Let me check Head_Smut.

Step 16: `View reference: Corn_Disease_139`

Step 17: None of these are strong matches. The test image shows tip damage with whitish material, which aligns best with Fusarium description ("whitish to pink fungal growth at ear tip"). Let me use my last view on another Fusarium reference.

Step 18: `View reference: Corn_Disease_42`

Step 19: This Fusarium reference shows whitish-pink mold on kernels with healthy kernels nearby, similar to the test image. The test image shows: - Damaged, discolored kernels concentrated at the ear tip - Whitish material between kernels - Rest of ear is healthy yellow - No green, pink, or dark colored mold

This matches Fusarium_Disease: "whitish to pink fungal growth at ear tip" with "kernels can also be infected without visible symptoms" for the scattered pattern.

Reasoning Trace: Mango Leaf Disease — Anthracnose__Mango_Leaf_105



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Anthracnose
Ground truth: Anthracnose
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.93

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows a mango leaf with discrete dark brown/black spots — irregular, somewhat sunken-looking lesions on the leaf surface. This matches Anthracnose (irregular brown-black spots on leaves) more than the others. Let me check reference images, one per class.

Step 3: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 4: That anthracnose reference shows a very yellowed/brown leaf — different from the test image. Let me check one from each remaining class.

Step 5: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_288`

Step 6: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_383`

Step 7: This anthracnose reference (Mango_Leaf_383) is a near-perfect match to the test image — green leaf with discrete dark brown/black irregular spots scattered across the surface. The sooty mould reference showed a more diffuse dark coating with a greyish cast, not discrete spots.

Summary of evidence: - Test image: green mango leaf, discrete dark brown-black irregular lesions scattered on surface - Anthracnose ref 383: identical pattern — green leaf, dark irregular spots, same morphology and distribution - Sooty mould ref: diffuse dark coating/encrustation, not discrete spots - Anthracnose KB: "oval or irregular brown to deep brown sunken spots on leaves" — matches exactly

Reasoning Trace: Mango Leaf Disease — Anthracnose__Mango_Leaf_289



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: internet
Reference budget (k): 4
Prediction: Powdery_Mildew
Ground truth: Anthracnose
Outcome: **Incorrect**
Confidence: 0.90

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows a mango leaf with white, powdery-looking patches on the surface. This strongly suggests Powdery_Mildew. Let me check one reference per class.

Step 3: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 4: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 5: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_147`

Step 6: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_166`

Step 7: Clear differentiation across all four classes:

- Test image: Green leaf with white/cream powdery patches concentrated on the surface - Powdery_Mildew ref: White/grey powdery deposits on a green leaf — matches the test image well - Anthracnose ref: Brown withered leaf with dark necrotic lesions — does not match - Sooty_Mould ref: Black soot-like deposits — opposite color (black vs white) - Die_Back ref: Completely brown, dried/curled leaf — does not match

The white powdery deposits on an otherwise green leaf are the defining feature of Powdery_Mildew. No brown lesions (Anthracnose), no black encrustations (Sooty_Mould), no wilting/browning (Die_Back).

Reasoning Trace: Mango Leaf Disease — Anthracnose__Mango_Leaf_105



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: no KB
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Anthracnose
Ground truth: Anthracnose
Outcome: **Correct**
Confidence: 0.95

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: Test image: A green mango leaf with several discrete, dark brown/black circular to irregular lesions scattered across the leaf surface. The spots appear sunken or necrotic with defined edges. No powdery coating, no tip dieback, no black sooty film. This pattern strongly suggests Anthracnose.

Let me view one reference from each class before deciding.

Step 3: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 4: This Anthracnose reference shows a mostly yellowed/brown leaf with extensive necrosis - different from the test image's discrete spots. Let me check other classes.

Step 5: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 6: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 7: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_147`

Step 8: Die_Back is fully dead/shriveled. Powdery_Mildew shows diffuse white coating. Sooty_Mould shows dark smudgy patches. The test image has discrete dark spots on a green leaf. Let me check more Anthracnose references.

Step 9: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_24`

Step 10: This matches the test image closely - green leaf with discrete dark brown/black lesions. Let me view one more Anthracnose and one more Sooty_Mould to be thorough.

Step 11: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_383`

Step 12: Excellent match. Let me use my final view on Sooty_Mould to rule it out.

Step 13: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_164`

Step 14: Sooty_Mould shows a diffuse dark film/coating along the leaf surface, not discrete spots. This confirms the test image is not Sooty_Mould.

Summary: - Test image: green mango leaf with discrete, well-defined dark brown/black necrotic spots scattered across it - Anthracnose (Mango_Leaf_24, Mango_Leaf_383): green leaves with identical discrete dark lesions — strong visual match - Die_Back: fully shriveled/brown dead tissue — no match - Powdery_Mildew: diffuse white powdery coating — no match - Sooty_Mould: dark smudgy film over leaf surface — no match

Reasoning Trace: Mango Leaf Disease — Anthracnose__Mango_Leaf_182



Test image

Model: sonnet
KB source: no KB
Reference budget (k): 8
Prediction: Sooty_Mould
Ground truth: Anthracnose
Outcome: **Incorrect**
Confidence: 0.72

Step 1: `Observe test image`

Step 2: The test image shows a mango leaf with small, dark brown/black scattered spots and lesions across the leaf surface. The leaf is green with irregular dark spots, some appearing as small necrotic lesions with irregular margins. No white powdery coating, no sooty black

coating, no tip dieback. This pattern suggests Anthracnose.

Let me view one reference per class before deciding.

Step 3: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 4: This Anthracnose reference shows a yellowed/tan leaf with severe tissue collapse. The test image looks greener with small scattered spots. Let me check Die_Back.

Step 5: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 6: Die_Back shows a completely brown/dead, shriveled leaf - very different from the test image. Let me check Powdery_Mildew.

Step 7: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_14`

Step 8: Powdery Mildew shows a grey-white powdery coating across the leaf surface - not matching the test image. Let me check Sooty_Mould.

Step 9: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_147`

Step 10: Sooty Mould shows dark scattered patches on a green leaf - somewhat similar to test image. Let me view another Anthracnose reference to compare more carefully.

Step 11: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_24`

Step 12: Anthracnose_24 shows larger coalescing dark brown lesions on green leaf. The test image spots are smaller and more scattered. Let me check another Sooty Mould reference.

Step 13: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_164`

Step 14: This Sooty Mould (164) looks very similar to the test image - wavy green leaf with small scattered dark spots. Let me check one more Sooty Mould and one more Anthracnose.

Step 15: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_288`

Step 16: `View reference: Mango_Leaf_383`

Step 17: Now I have a clear comparison:

- Anthracnose_383: Larger, well-defined dark brown lesions with clear margins on a green leaf - Sooty_Mould_164: Wavy green leaf with small scattered dark spots - very close to the test image - Sooty_Mould_288: Green leaf with small scattered dark spots and some grey patches

The test image (wavy green leaf, small scattered dark spots) most closely matches Sooty Mould references, particularly Mango_Leaf_164. The spots in the test image are smaller and more numerous than typical Anthracnose lesions which tend to be larger with distinct margins.

J. SAGE: Scalable Agentic Grounded Evaluation

J.1. Problem Setup

Let $\mathcal{C} = \{c_1, \ldots, c_n\}$ denote the set of crops and $\mathcal{D} = \{d_1, \ldots, d_m\}$ denote the set of known diseases. Each disease $d \in \mathcal{D}$ has:

- Affected organs: $\mathcal{O}_d \subseteq \mathcal{O}$, where $\mathcal{O}$ is the set of all plant organs (leaf, stem, root, etc.)
- Symptom descriptions: $\mathcal{S}_d = \{s_1, s_2, \ldots\}$, each with provenance $p(s_i)$ linking to a source quote.

Let $\mathcal{I} = \{I_1, \ldots, I_q\}$ denote web images. The diagnostic function is defined as:

$$f_{\text{SAGE}} : I_{\text{test}} \times \text{KB} \times \mathcal{R} \to (d^*, c, \tau)$$

where d^* is the predicted disease, c is the confidence, and τ is the reasoning trace.

J.2. Phase 1: Knowledge Base Curation

Discovery Agent: For each $(c, d) \in \mathcal{C} \times \mathcal{D}$, issue web queries:

$$\mathcal{W}_{c,d} = \text{WebQuery}(c, d)$$

Extraction Agent: Extract structured facts from sources:

$$\mathcal{F}_w = \{(p, t, \mathcal{O}, \mathcal{S})\}, \quad \forall w \in \mathcal{W}_{c,d}$$

Attach provenance $p(s)$ to each symptom $s \in \mathcal{S}$.

Reconciliation Agent: Resolve conflicts:

$$\text{KB} = \text{Reconcile}\Big(\bigcup_{w} \mathcal{F}_w\Big)$$

Filtering & Tagging VLM: For each image $I \in \mathcal{I}$:

$$\hat{o} = \text{DetectOrgan}(I), \quad m(I, d) = \text{MatchSymptoms}(I, \mathcal{S}_d)$$

Keep images where $m(I, d) \geq \theta$ and assign anatomical tags.

J.3. Phase 2: Agentic Inference

Observation:

$$o_{\text{test}} = \text{DetectOrgan}(I_{\text{test}}), \quad \mathcal{S}_{\text{test}} = \text{DescribeSymptoms}(I_{\text{test}})$$

Narrow Candidates:

$$\mathcal{D}_{\text{cand}} = \{d \in \mathcal{D} \mid o_{\text{test}} \in \mathcal{O}_d\}, \quad \mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}} = \text{RankBySymptoms}(\mathcal{D}_{\text{cand}}, \mathcal{S}_{\text{test}})$$

Sequential Comparison Loop: Given reference budget k, for $i = 1 \ldots k$:

1. Select candidate disease $d_i = \text{NextCandidate}(\mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}})$
2. Fetch reference image $I_{\text{ref}} = \text{FetchReferenceImage}(\mathcal{R}, d_i, o_{\text{test}})$
3. Compare and reason:

$$r_i = \text{CompareAndReason}(I_{\text{test}}, I_{\text{ref}}, \mathcal{S}_{d_i})$$

Update reasoning trace $\tau \leftarrow \tau \cup \{r_i\}$
Remove rejected candidates until confident.

Prediction:

$$d^* = \arg\max_{d \in \mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}}} \text{Support}(d, \tau), \quad c = \text{Confidence}(d^*, \tau)$$

Algorithm 1 SAGE: Agentic Inference

Require: Test image I_{test}, KB, Reference set $\mathcal{R}$, Anatomical Index, Reference budget k
Ensure: Predicted disease d^*, confidence c, reasoning trace τ

$o_{\text{test}} \leftarrow \text{DetectOrgan}(I_{\text{test}})$
$\mathcal{S}_{\text{test}} \leftarrow \text{DescribeSymptoms}(I_{\text{test}})$
$\mathcal{D}_{\text{cand}} \leftarrow \{d \in \mathcal{D} \mid o_{\text{test}} \in \mathcal{O}_d\}$
$\mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}} \leftarrow \text{RankBySymptoms}(\mathcal{D}_{\text{cand}}, \mathcal{S}_{\text{test}})$
$\tau \leftarrow []$
for $i = 1$ **to** k **do**
    if Confident($\mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}}$) **then**
        break
    end if
    $d_i \leftarrow \text{NextCandidate}(\mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}})$
    $I_{\text{ref}} \leftarrow \text{FetchReferenceImage}(\mathcal{R}, d_i, o_{\text{test}})$
    $r_i \leftarrow \text{CompareAndReason}(I_{\text{test}}, I_{\text{ref}}, \mathcal{S}_{d_i})$
    τ.append(r_i)
    if r_i rejects d_i **then**
        $\mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}}$.remove($d_i$)
    end if
end for
$d^* \leftarrow \arg\max_{d \in \mathcal{D}_{\text{rank}}} \text{Support}(d, \tau)$
$c \leftarrow \text{Confidence}(d^*, \tau)$
return d^*, c, τ